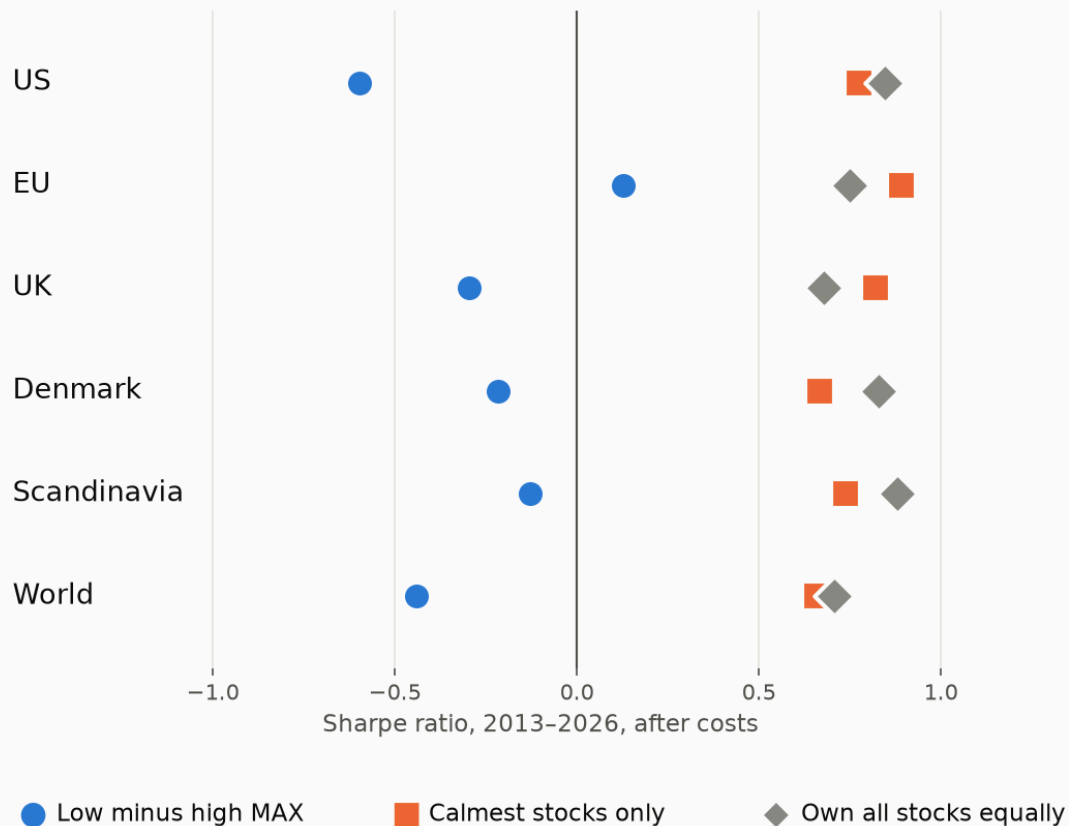


# The lottery factor

Do investors overpay for stocks that just had one huge day?



**The anomaly was beta in disguise. Hedge it, and nothing is left.**

Henrik Gjerner · Project 10 · point-in-time universes, local currency (World in USD)

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Would you buy a lottery ticket? Many investors do, in stock form: they chase the stocks that just had one spectacular day.

Bali, Cakici & Whitelaw (2011) showed that US stocks with the biggest one-day jump last month earned about 1% a month less afterwards. Investors overpay for the thrill.

I tested it in six markets, 2013–2026, point-in-time members, after costs. Buying the calmest stocks and shorting the most lottery-like lost money in 5 of six markets (-11% to +2% a year).

The catch is beta. Lottery stocks carry a beta of about 1.3, calm stocks about 0.7. In a 13-year bull market that alone decides the race. Hedge the beta and the loss disappears, and so does the premium: -2.2% a year,  $t$  -0.6.

The calm stocks on their own still did what low-risk investing promises: smaller drawdowns than owning all the stocks in all six markets and a better Sharpe in 2 of six.

Where does it fit? Not a factor of its own, but a noisier member of the low-risk family.

Full factsheet: <https://hgjerner.github.io/now-showing/factsheets/fs02-lottery-max>

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